PRAVEEN V 241901082

Exercise 8
Web Spidering

AIM

To perform web spidering on an authorized training website using OWASP ZAP or Burp Suite, examine robots.txt and sitemap.xml where available, and compare manually discovered pages with the crawler results.

PROCEDURE

a) Examining robots.txt and sitemap.xml

1. Open a browser and navigate to the target website (testphp.vulnweb.com).
2. Check for the robots.txt file by visiting: testphp.vulnweb.com/robots.txt
3. Note down the Disallowed/Allowed paths listed, as they often reveal hidden or restricted directories.
4. Check for a sitemap file by visiting: testphp.vulnweb.com/sitemap.xml
5. If present, note down all the URLs listed in the sitemap.

b) Web Spidering Using OWASP ZAP / Burp Suite and Comparison

1. Manually browse the website, clicking all visible links, and note down each page discovered (manual list).
2. Open OWASP ZAP, set the browser proxy to route through ZAP (127.0.0.1:8080), and set the target URL.

3. Right-click the target site in ZAP and select Attack → Spider, then start the spider.
4. Wait for the spider to complete and view all URLs discovered under the Sites tab.
5. Alternatively, use Burp Suite Spider: set the target in scope, right-click → Spider this host, and view the results under Target → Site Map.
6. Compare the manually discovered page list with the spider/crawler results and note any additional pages found only by the crawler (hidden/unlinked pages).
7.

OBSERVATION TABLE

S.No	Source	Pages/URLs Discovered	Observation
1	robots.txt	Disallowed paths (e.g., /admin/, /CVS/)	Hidden directories revealed
2	sitemap.xml	Listed URLs	Not available / limited URLs listed
3	Manual browsing	Pages found by clicking links	Only linked pages discovered
4	OWASP ZAP Spider	All crawled pages and parameters	Additional unlinked pages found
5	Comparison	Manual list vs Spider list	Extra hidden pages identified only by spider

OUTPUT

robots.txt content:

User-agent: *

Disallow: /admin/

Disallow: /CVS/

sitemap.xml:

Not found (404) on target site

Manually discovered pages:

/index.php

/login.php

/signup.php

/search.php

/listproducts.php

/guestbook.php

OWASP ZAP Spider results:

/index.php

/login.php

/signup.php

/search.php

/listproducts.php

/listproducts.php?cat=2

/listproducts.php?cat=3

/product.php?pic=1

/guestbook.php

/AJAX/index.php

/admin/ (from robots.txt, not linked)

/CVS/ (from robots.txt, not linked)

Comparison result:

Pages found only by spider: /listproducts.php?cat=2, /listproducts.php?cat=3, /product.php?pic=1, /AJAX/index.php, /admin/, /CVS/

RESULT

Thus, web spidering was successfully performed on the authorized training website using OWASP ZAP. The robots.txt and sitemap.xml files were examined, and the manually discovered pages were compared with the crawler results, revealing additional hidden pages found only through spidering.